

Word family: LANGUAGE / LANGUAGES / LANGUAGE-RELATED / LANGUAGING / METALANGUAGE / PARALANGUAGE

Base word: language

Plural: languages

Part of speech: noun (名詞); attributive noun in compounds (名詞作前置修飾語)

Less-common related use: languaging

Related lexical forms: metalanguage, paralanguage, multilingual, bilingual, monolingual, linguistic, linguistically

Important family note: forms such as **linguistic, linguist, bilingual, multilingual** are not simple transparent suffix formations from the spelling *language*, but they are essential members of the practical lexical field and are included in the family sweep.

Major useful extensions

body language, spoken language, written language, sign language, natural language, human language, first language, native language, mother tongue, second language, foreign language, additional language, target language, source language, heritage language, minority language, community language, official language, national language, common language, shared language, international language, endangered language, extinct language, living language, dead language, classical language, constructed language, artificial language, language family, language acquisition, language learning, language development, language skills, language ability, language proficiency, language barrier, language exchange, language immersion, language education, language learner, language teacher, language school, language test, language policy, language use, language choice, language contact, language change, language variety, standard language, plain language, formal language, informal language, everyday language, academic language, technical language, legal language, medical language, figurative language, literal language, persuasive language, discriminatory language, inclusive language, offensive language, strong language, bad language, foul language, abusive language, threatening language, obscene language, colourful language, diplomatic language, careful language, vague language, precise language, loaded language, emotive language, wording, terminology, jargon, visual language, cinematic language, musical language, language of art, language of mathematics, love language, programming language, machine language, assembly language, high-level language, scripting language, query language, markup language, formal language, natural-language processing, natural-language understanding, language model, large language model, language generation, language detection, language setting, language pack, language support, language data, metalanguage, paralanguage, language of instruction.

A. PASSAGE ANCHOR — BODY LANGUAGE

1. body language = bodily behavior that communicates feelings, attitudes, intentions, etc. — 肢體語言 ; 身體語言

Passage anchor

“At first glance, the task looked simple; on closer inspection, it forced us to consider tone, **body language** and responsibility.”

Meaning

Here, **language** does **not** mean English, Chinese, French, etc.

In **body language**, **language** means:

a system or means through which meaning is communicated

表達／傳遞意思的方式或系統

And **body language** means:

meaning communicated through posture, facial expression, gaze, movement, gesture, physical distance, etc., rather than only through words

肢體語言 ; 透過姿勢、表情、眼神、動作等傳達的非語言訊息

Practice 1

Her **body language** showed that she was uncomfortable.

她的肢體語言顯示她感到不自在。

Practice 2

Actors must think carefully about both words and **body language**.

演員必須仔細考慮台詞和肢體語言。

B. LANGUAGE — HUMAN COMMUNICATION SYSTEM

2. language = structured human system of communication — 語言

Meaning

A system using sounds, signs, words, grammar, etc. through which humans communicate.

Practice

1. **Language** allows people to share complex ideas.
語言讓人們能交流複雜概念。
2. Children develop **language** rapidly in early childhood.
兒童在幼年時期迅速發展語言能力。

This is the broad central sense.

C. A PARTICULAR LANGUAGE

3. a language = one particular linguistic system — 一種語言

Practice

1. Cantonese is a **language**.
粵語是一種語言。
2. How many **languages** do you speak?
你會說多少種語言？

This countable sense refers to individual systems such as English, Japanese, Arabic, etc.

D. SPOKEN LANGUAGE

4. spoken language

= language produced through speech

口語; 口頭語言

Practice

1. **Spoken language** often differs from formal writing.
口語往往與正式書面語不同。
-

E. WRITTEN LANGUAGE

5. written language

= language represented in writing

書面語; 書面語言

Practice

1. Academic **written language** can be highly formal.
學術書面語可以相當正式。
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F. SIGN LANGUAGE

6. sign language

= natural language expressed primarily through visible manual and bodily signs

手語

Practice

1. She communicates using **sign language**.
她使用手語溝通。

Important distinction

A natural sign language is a complete **language**, not merely a collection of gestures.

sign language
→ 手語

is therefore different from:

gesture
→ 手勢／表意動作

G. NATURAL LANGUAGE

7. natural language

= language that develops naturally within human communities, rather than being designed as a formal computer/mathematical system
自然語言

Examples include:

- Cantonese
- English
- Korean
- Arabic

Practice

1. Computers increasingly process **natural language**.
電腦越來越能處理自然語言。
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H. HUMAN LANGUAGE

8. human language

= language as a specifically human communication capacity/system

人類語言

Used especially in linguistics, cognitive science, and AI.

I. FIRST LANGUAGE

9. first language / L1

= language acquired first, usually in early childhood

第一語言

Practice

1. Cantonese is her **first language**.

粵語是她的第一語言。

This is often more precise than **native language** in linguistic contexts.

J. NATIVE LANGUAGE

10. native language

= language a person has acquired naturally from early life and uses as a native speaker

母語; 本族語

Practice

1. English is not his **native language**.

英語不是他的母語。

K. MOTHER TONGUE

11. mother tongue

= native/first language

母語

Practice

1. She teaches children in their **mother tongue**.
她使用孩子的母語教學。

Established expression.

L. SECOND LANGUAGE

12. second language / L2

= language learned in addition to one's first language, especially where it has substantial social use

第二語言

Practice

1. She learned English as a **second language**.
她把英語作為第二語言學習。

M. FOREIGN LANGUAGE

13. foreign language

= language from another country/community, especially one not widely used in the learner's immediate environment

外語

Practice

1. Students study a **foreign language** at school.
學生在學校學習一門外語。
-

N. ADDITIONAL LANGUAGE

14. additional language

= any language learned in addition to languages someone already knows
額外語言; 附加語言

Modern education term that avoids assuming a simple first/second-language sequence.

O. TARGET LANGUAGE

15. target language

Language learning/translation:

A. learning

= language a learner is trying to learn
目標語

B. translation

= language into which something is translated
譯入語; 目標語

Practice

1. Try to use the **target language** during the activity.
活動期間盡量使用目標語。
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P. SOURCE LANGUAGE

16. source language

Translation:

= language from which text/speech is translated

原文語言；源語

Example

English was the **source language**, and Chinese was the target language.

英語是源語，中文是目標語。

Q. HERITAGE LANGUAGE

17. heritage language

= language associated with a person's family/community heritage and learned or maintained alongside a dominant societal language

傳承語；祖語／族裔傳承語言

Practice

1. The school offers classes for **heritage language** learners.
學校為傳承語學習者提供課程。
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R. COMMUNITY LANGUAGE

18. community language

= language used within a particular local, ethnic, cultural, or social community

社群語言；社區語言

S. MINORITY LANGUAGE

19. minority language

= language spoken by a numerically or socially non-dominant group in a region/state
少數語言

T. MAJORITY / DOMINANT LANGUAGE

20. majority language

= language spoken by the majority population
多數語言

21. dominant language

= language holding greater social, institutional, political, or economic power
主導語言 ; 強勢語言

These concepts overlap but are not always identical.

U. OFFICIAL LANGUAGE

22. official language

= language officially designated for governmental/legal/institutional use
官方語言

Practice

1. The country has several **official languages**.
該國有數種官方語言。
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V. NATIONAL LANGUAGE

23. national language

= language symbolically or legally associated with a nation
國家語言；國語

It does not automatically mean exactly the same thing as **official language**.

W. COMMON / SHARED LANGUAGE

24. common language

A. language both/all parties know

共同語言

B. shared vocabulary or conceptual framework

共同的表達方式／共同語彙

Practice

1. They needed a **common language** to communicate.
他們需要一種共同語言才能溝通。
 2. The two professions lack a **common language**.
兩個專業領域缺乏一套共同語彙／共同溝通框架。
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X. LINGUA FRANCA

25. lingua franca

= language used as a common means of communication among speakers with different first languages

通用語 ; 共同語

Important lexical neighbor.

Y. INTERNATIONAL / GLOBAL LANGUAGE

26. international language

= language used across national boundaries

國際通用語言

27. global language

= language with particularly widespread international use

全球性語言

Z. LIVING LANGUAGE

28. living language

= language still used naturally by a community

活語言 ; 仍有人使用的語言

AA. DEAD LANGUAGE

29. dead language

= language no longer acquired as a native everyday language by a speech community
死語; 不再作為母語使用的語言

A dead language can still be studied or used ceremonially.

AB. EXTINCT LANGUAGE

30. extinct language

= language with no remaining speakers
滅絕語言

More specific than **dead language**.

AC. ENDANGERED LANGUAGE

31. endangered language

= language at risk of losing its speaker community and becoming extinct
瀕危語言

Practice

1. Researchers are documenting **endangered languages**.
研究人員正在記錄瀕危語言。
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AD. REVITALIZED / REVIVED LANGUAGE

32. language revitalization

= efforts to increase use, transmission, and vitality of an endangered or declining language
語言復振; 語言復興

AE. CLASSICAL LANGUAGE

33. classical language

= historically important older language/literary variety with an established cultural tradition
古典語言

Examples depend on cultural context.

AF. CONSTRUCTED LANGUAGE

34. constructed language / conlang

= language deliberately designed rather than naturally developing through ordinary community transmission
人工構造語; 人造語言

AG. ARTIFICIAL LANGUAGE

35. artificial language

= deliberately designed language or formal symbolic system
人工語言

Depending on context, may include constructed human languages or formal/computational languages.

AH. LANGUAGE FAMILY

36. language family

= group of languages historically descended from a common ancestral language
語系

Practice

1. English belongs to the Indo-European **language family**.
英語屬於印歐語系。
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AI. LANGUAGE GROUP / BRANCH

37. language branch

= subgroup within a language family
語族／語支

Specialist linguistic use.

AJ. LANGUAGE VARIETY

38. language variety

Linguistics:

= any distinguishable form of a language associated with region, social group, situation, etc.
語言變體

This can include dialects, registers, sociolects, etc.

AK. STANDARD LANGUAGE

39. standard language

= socially/institutionally standardized variety used in formal education, publishing, administration, etc.

標準語

AL. VERNACULAR LANGUAGE

40. vernacular

= ordinary language/variety used by a community in everyday life

日常本地語 ; 通俗語

Important lexical neighbor.

AM. LANGUAGE ACQUISITION

41. language acquisition

= process by which language ability develops, often especially naturally rather than through explicit study

語言習得

Practice

1. Researchers study early **language acquisition**.

研究人員研究兒童早期的語言習得。

AN. SECOND-LANGUAGE ACQUISITION

42. second-language acquisition / SLA

= study/process of acquiring an additional language
第二語言習得

Established academic field.

AO. LANGUAGE LEARNING

43. language learning

= process of learning a language
語言學習

Broader everyday term than technical **acquisition**.

AP. LANGUAGE DEVELOPMENT

44. language development

= growth of language abilities over time
語言發展

Practice

1. Reading supports children's **language development**.
閱讀有助兒童的語言發展。
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AQ. LANGUAGE SKILLS

45. language skills

= abilities in using language
語言技能

Often includes:

- listening
 - speaking
 - reading
 - writing
-

AR. LANGUAGE ABILITY

46. language ability

= general capacity to understand/use language
語言能力

AS. LANGUAGE PROFICIENCY

47. language proficiency

= degree of skill in using a language effectively
語言熟練程度 ; 語言能力水平

Practice

1. Applicants must demonstrate sufficient **language proficiency**.
申請人必須證明具備足夠的語言能力。
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AT. LANGUAGE COMPETENCE / COMPETENCY

48. language competence

= underlying knowledge/ability enabling language use
語言能力

Technical meanings vary by linguistic/educational framework.

AU. LANGUAGE BARRIER

49. language barrier

= difficulty communicating because people do not share sufficient language ability
語言障礙

Practice

1. A **language barrier** made communication difficult.
語言障礙令溝通變得困難。

Very high-value expression.

AV. LANGUAGE EXCHANGE

50. language exchange

= arrangement in which people help each other practise different languages
語言交換

AW. LANGUAGE IMMERSION

51. language immersion

= learning approach involving extensive use/exposure to the target language
語言沉浸; 沉浸式語言學習

AX. LANGUAGE EDUCATION

52. language education

= teaching and learning of languages

語言教育

AY. LANGUAGE LEARNER

53. language learner

= person learning a language

語言學習者

AZ. LANGUAGE TEACHER

54. language teacher

= teacher specializing in a language

語言教師

BA. LANGUAGE SCHOOL

55. language school

= institution specializing in language courses

語言學校

BB. LANGUAGE COURSE

56. language course

= course for learning a language

語言課程

BC. LANGUAGE TEST

57. language test

= assessment of language ability

語言測驗

BD. LANGUAGE REQUIREMENT

58. language requirement

= required language ability/qualification for admission, employment, etc.

語言要求

BE. LANGUAGE OF INSTRUCTION

59. language of instruction

= language used to teach academic content

教學語言 ; 授課語言

Practice

1. English is the **language of instruction**.
英語是授課語言。
-

BF. MEDIUM OF INSTRUCTION

60. medium of instruction

= language used for teaching
教學語言

Common education-policy term.

BG. LANGUAGE POLICY

61. language policy

= rules/principles governing language use in institutions, education, government, etc.
語言政策

BH. LANGUAGE PLANNING

62. language planning

= organized efforts to influence language status, use, form, or development
語言規劃

Specialist sociolinguistic term.

BI. LANGUAGE USE

63. language use

= actual ways language is used in communication
語言使用

BJ. LANGUAGE CHOICE

64. language choice

= choice of which language/variety to use in a particular context
語言選擇

BK. LANGUAGE CONTACT

65. language contact

= interaction between speakers/languages that can lead to borrowing, bilingualism, structural influence, etc.
語言接觸

Established linguistics term.

BL. LANGUAGE CHANGE

66. language change

= evolution of pronunciation, grammar, vocabulary, meaning, etc. over time
語言變化; 語言演變

BM. LANGUAGE SHIFT

67. language shift

= community gradually replacing one language with another
語言轉移

Specialist sociolinguistic term.

BN. LANGUAGE MAINTENANCE

68. language maintenance

= continued use/transmission of a language despite pressure toward another language
語言維持

BO. LANGUAGE LOSS / ATTRITION

69. language loss

= decline/loss of ability in a language or disappearance from a community
語言流失

70. language attrition

= gradual loss of individual language proficiency through reduced use/exposure
語言磨蝕; 語言能力流失

BP. LANGUAGE = WORDING / WAY OF EXPRESSING SOMETHING

71. language = words and expressions used to communicate something — 措辭; 用語

Practice

1. The contract uses complicated **language**.
合約使用了複雜的措辭。
2. Please simplify the **language**.
請簡化用語。

Major distinct sense.

Here **language** does not mean “English versus Chinese”; it means **the wording chosen**.

BQ. SIMPLE / CLEAR LANGUAGE

72. simple language

= easy-to-understand wording
簡單易懂的用語

73. clear language

= wording that communicates meaning clearly
清晰用語

BR. PLAIN LANGUAGE

74. plain language

= clear, direct language designed to be understood easily by its intended audience
淺白語言；簡明用語

Practice

1. The guide is written in **plain language**.
指南以淺白易懂的語言寫成。

High-value professional term.

BS. EVERYDAY LANGUAGE

75. everyday language

= ordinary words/expressions used in daily communication
日常用語

BT. FORMAL LANGUAGE — STYLE

76. formal language

= language suitable for formal, professional, academic, ceremonial, etc. contexts
正式用語；正式語體

Practice

1. The letter uses highly **formal language**.
那封信使用非常正式的用語。

Note: **formal language** also has a separate mathematics/computing sense later.

BU. INFORMAL LANGUAGE

77. informal language

= relaxed/conversational language used in less formal contexts

非正式用語；口語化表達

BV. COLLOQUIAL LANGUAGE

78. colloquial language

= conversational language typical of ordinary speech

口語；俗語式表達

BW. ACADEMIC LANGUAGE

79. academic language

= vocabulary, grammar, and discourse conventions characteristic of academic study

學術語言；學術用語

BX. PROFESSIONAL LANGUAGE

80. professional language

= wording/register appropriate to professional contexts

專業用語；專業語氣

BY. TECHNICAL LANGUAGE

81. technical language

= specialized terminology and expression associated with a technical field
技術用語; 專門術語

Practice

1. The manual contains a lot of **technical language**.
手冊包含大量技術用語。
-

BZ. SPECIALIST LANGUAGE

82. specialist language

= language specific to a field or profession
專業術語; 專門用語

CA. LEGAL LANGUAGE

83. legal language

= terminology/style used in law and legal documents
法律用語; 法律文字

Practice

1. The agreement contains difficult **legal language**.
協議包含艱深的法律用語。
-

CB. MEDICAL LANGUAGE

84. medical language

= medical terminology/expression

醫學用語

CC. BUSINESS LANGUAGE

85. business language

= vocabulary/style associated with business contexts

商業用語 ; 商務語言

Can also mean a language valuable for international business depending on context.

CD. JARGON

86. jargon

= specialized language used by a profession/group, often difficult for outsiders

行話 ; 專業術語

Contrast

technical language

may be neutrally necessary.

jargon

often emphasizes insider terminology or unnecessary complexity.

CE. TERMINOLOGY

87. terminology

= set of specialized terms used in a field
術語 ; 術語系統

language is broader than **terminology**.

CF. WORDING

88. wording

= exact choice and arrangement of words
措辭

Compare:

legal language
法律用語／法律語體

exact wording of the clause
條款的確切措辭

CG. FIGURATIVE LANGUAGE

89. figurative language

= language whose meaning is not purely literal, including metaphor, simile, personification, etc.
比喻性語言 ; 修辭性語言

Practice

1. Poetry often uses **figurative language**.
詩歌經常使用比喻性語言。
-

CH. LITERAL LANGUAGE

90. literal language

= language intended according to its direct/non-figurative meaning

字面語言；直述用語

CI. DESCRIPTIVE LANGUAGE

91. descriptive language

= language chosen to create vivid descriptions

描寫性語言

CJ. PERSUASIVE LANGUAGE

92. persuasive language

= language designed to influence beliefs or actions

說服性語言

CK. EMOTIVE LANGUAGE

93. emotive language

= wording selected to provoke emotional reactions

情感性用語；煽動情緒的措辭

Practice

1. The advertisement uses highly **emotive language**.
廣告使用大量帶強烈情緒效果的措辭。

CL. LOADED LANGUAGE

94. loaded language

= wording carrying strong positive/negative associations that can influence interpretation
帶有強烈傾向／暗示的措辭

Practice

1. Avoid **loaded language** in a neutral report.
中立報告應避免使用帶有強烈傾向的措辭。

CM. NEUTRAL LANGUAGE

95. neutral language

= wording that avoids strong evaluation or bias
中性用語

CN. INCLUSIVE LANGUAGE

96. inclusive language

= language intended to avoid excluding or unnecessarily stigmatizing groups of people
共融用語；包容性語言

Practice

1. The guide recommends **inclusive language**.
指南建議使用共融用語。
-

CO. DISCRIMINATORY LANGUAGE

97. discriminatory language

= wording that discriminates against or disparages people based on group identity/status
歧視性語言

CP. OFFENSIVE LANGUAGE

98. offensive language

= words/expressions likely to offend, insult, or shock
冒犯性用語

CQ. STRONG LANGUAGE

99. strong language

= forceful, sometimes offensive or profane wording
強烈措辭；粗俗／不雅用語

Practice

1. The film contains **strong language**.
電影包含粗俗／不雅用語。

Very common content-warning expression.

CR. BAD LANGUAGE

100. bad language

= swear words/profanity

粗言穢語 ; 髒話

Practice

1. The teacher warned him about using **bad language**.
老師警告他不要說粗言穢語。
-

CS. FOUL LANGUAGE

101. foul language

= highly offensive, obscene, or profane language

粗言穢語 ; 髒話

Stronger than neutral **offensive language**.

CT. ABUSIVE LANGUAGE

102. abusive language

= insulting, degrading, threatening, or verbally abusive words

辱罵性語言 ; 侮辱性用語

CU. THREATENING LANGUAGE

103. threatening language

= wording communicating threats
威脅性言語

CV. OBSCENE LANGUAGE

104. obscene language

= sexually explicit/grossly offensive wording
猥褻／粗俗用語

CW. COLOURFUL / COLORFUL LANGUAGE

105. colourful language

Can mean:

A. vivid, expressive wording

生動的用語

B. euphemistically, profanity

粗俗而強烈的用語

Context decides.

CX. MIND / WATCH YOUR LANGUAGE

106. mind your language / watch your language

= stop using rude, offensive, or inappropriate words
注意你的用詞；別說髒話

Practice

1. **Watch your language.**
注意你的用詞／別說髒話。

Very high-value idiom.

CY. EXCUSE / PARDON MY LANGUAGE

107. excuse my language / pardon my language

= apology before/after using rude, blunt, or strong wording
請原諒我用詞粗魯／說得難聽

CZ. LANGUAGE = MANNER OF EXPRESSION

108. language = characteristic manner in which someone expresses ideas — 表達方式；語言風格

Practice

1. The writer's **language** is simple but powerful.
作者的語言風格簡潔而有力。
 2. The poem's **language** is highly symbolic.
這首詩的表達方式極具象徵性。
-

DA. POETIC LANGUAGE

109. poetic language

= language characteristic of poetry or rich in imagery/rhythm/figurative expression

詩性語言 ; 詩歌語言

DB. LITERARY LANGUAGE

110. literary language

= language characteristic of literature or literary style

文學語言

DC. DIPLOMATIC LANGUAGE

111. diplomatic language

= careful wording intended to avoid unnecessary offense/conflict

外交式措辭 ; 委婉謹慎的語言

Practice

1. The statement used carefully chosen **diplomatic language**.

聲明採用了精心選擇的外交式措辭。

DD. EUPHEMISTIC LANGUAGE

112. euphemistic language

= indirect/milder wording substituted for something unpleasant or sensitive

委婉語 ; 委婉措辭

DE. PRECISE LANGUAGE

113. precise language

= exact and unambiguous wording

精確用語

DF. VAGUE LANGUAGE

114. vague language

= wording lacking precision or clear boundaries

模糊用語

DG. AMBIGUOUS LANGUAGE

115. ambiguous language

= wording capable of more than one interpretation

含糊／歧義性語言

DH. CAREFUL LANGUAGE

116. careful language

= deliberately chosen wording, often to avoid misunderstanding/offense

謹慎措辭

DI. BODY LANGUAGE — DETAILED BRANCH

117. body language

Includes communicative information from:

- posture
- facial expression
- eye contact
- gesture
- bodily orientation
- movement
- physical distance

肢體語言

Important

Body language is not literally a fully grammatical language system in the same technical sense as English or a natural sign language.

In ordinary English, **language** here is metaphorically extended to mean:

system of meaningful signals

DJ. POSITIVE / NEGATIVE BODY LANGUAGE

118. positive body language

= bodily behavior conventionally interpreted as openness, confidence, engagement, etc.

正面的肢體語言

119. negative body language

= bodily behavior interpreted as discomfort, hostility, withdrawal, etc.

負面的肢體語言

Interpretation remains context- and culture-dependent.

DK. READ SOMEONE'S BODY LANGUAGE

120. read body language

= interpret meaning from someone's nonverbal behavior

解讀肢體語言

Practice

1. Actors learn to **read body language**.

演員學習如何解讀肢體語言。

DL. LANGUAGE OF SOMETHING — FIGURATIVE SYSTEM OF EXPRESSION

121. the language of something

= characteristic system of signs, forms, conventions, or expressions through which something communicates meaning

.....的語言／表達系統

Examples:

- language of art
- language of music
- language of mathematics
- language of film
- language of architecture

This is the broader metaphor behind **body language**.

DM. LANGUAGE OF ART

122. language of art

= visual/formal means through which art communicates

藝術語言

May include:

- line
 - form
 - colour
 - composition
 - symbolism
-

DN. VISUAL LANGUAGE

123. visual language

= system of visual elements used to communicate meaning

視覺語言

Practice

1. The brand has a distinctive **visual language**.
該品牌具有鮮明的視覺語言。

High-value design/art term.

DO. CINEMATIC / FILMIC LANGUAGE

124. cinematic language / film language

= conventions and techniques through which film communicates meaning

電影語言 ; 影像語言

May include:

- framing
 - camera movement
 - editing
 - lighting
 - sound
-

DP. MUSICAL LANGUAGE

125. musical language

= characteristic system/style of musical expression

音樂語言

Practice

1. The composer developed a distinctive **musical language**.
作曲家發展出獨特的音樂語言。
-

DQ. LANGUAGE OF MATHEMATICS

126. language of mathematics

= symbols, conventions, structures, and terminology used to express mathematical ideas

數學語言

DR. LANGUAGE OF SCIENCE

127. language of science

= terminology and conventions through which scientific ideas are expressed
科學語言

DS. LOVE LANGUAGE

128. love language

= preferred way a person is said to express or receive affection in a popular relationship framework
愛的語言 ; 表達 / 接收愛意的方式

Practice

1. They talked about their different **love languages**.
他們談到彼此不同的愛的表達方式。

Established popular-psychology term.

DT. COMMON LANGUAGE — FIGURATIVE UNDERSTANDING

129. speak the same language

Figurative:

= understand each other because of similar ideas, priorities, methods, etc.
有共同語言 ; 彼此很合拍

Practice

1. The designers and engineers finally began to **speak the same language**.
設計師與工程師終於開始有共同語言。
-

DU. NOT SPEAK THE SAME LANGUAGE

130. not speak the same language

A. literal

= not know a shared linguistic system
語言不通

B. figurative

= think about a subject in very different ways
沒有共同語言；彼此想法完全不同

DV. SPEAK SOMEONE'S LANGUAGE

131. speak someone's language

Figurative:

= communicate in terms that strongly appeal to or make sense to someone
說到某人的心坎／使用對方熟悉的表達方式

Practice

1. "More flexibility and less paperwork? Now you're **speaking my language**."
「更有彈性、少點文書工作？這可真是說到我心坎裡了。」

Very high-value idiom.

DW. LANGUAGE = TERMINOLOGY OF A GROUP

132. language of a profession/group

= distinctive terms and expressions used by a community
行業用語 ; 群體語彙

Practice

1. New employees must learn the **language of the industry**.
新員工需要學習這個行業的專門用語。

DX. THE LANGUAGE OF BUSINESS / LAW / MEDICINE

133. language of business

= terminology/concepts typical of business
商業語言 / 商務用語

134. language of law

= legal terminology and modes of expression
法律語言

135. language of medicine

= medical terminology and professional expression
醫學語言

DY. PROGRAMMING LANGUAGE

136. programming language

= formally defined language used to write computer programs
程式語言; 編程語言

Practice

1. Python is a **programming language**.
Python 是一種程式語言。

Major modern technical branch.

DZ. HIGH-LEVEL LANGUAGE

137. high-level language

= programming language relatively abstracted from machine hardware
高階程式語言

EA. LOW-LEVEL LANGUAGE

138. low-level language

= programming language close to machine-level operations/hardware
低階程式語言

EB. MACHINE LANGUAGE

139. machine language

= instructions represented in a form directly executable by a computer processor
機器語言; 機器碼

Practice

1. Processors ultimately execute **machine language**.
處理器最終執行機器語言。

EC. ASSEMBLY LANGUAGE

140. assembly language

= low-level programming language using symbolic instructions corresponding closely to machine instructions
組合語言; 匯編語言

ED. SCRIPTING LANGUAGE

141. scripting language

= programming language commonly used for automation, scripting, orchestration, etc.
腳本語言

EE. QUERY LANGUAGE

142. query language

= formal language used to request/manipulate information in a data system
查詢語言

Example:

SQL is commonly described as a query language.

EF. MARKUP LANGUAGE

143. markup language

= notation system for structuring/annotating documents and data

標記語言

Example:

HTML = HyperText Markup Language

EG. DOMAIN-SPECIFIC LANGUAGE

144. domain-specific language / DSL

Computing:

= language designed for a particular application domain

領域特定語言 ; 特定領域語言

EH. FORMAL LANGUAGE — MATHEMATICS / COMPUTING

145. formal language

Computer science/mathematics:

= precisely defined set of strings over an alphabet governed by formal rules

形式語言

This is completely different from:

formal language = 正式用語

Context is crucial.

EI. FORMAL LANGUAGE THEORY

146. formal language theory

= mathematical study of formal languages and grammars
形式語言理論

Specialist computing/mathematics term.

EJ. LANGUAGE SYNTAX — COMPUTING

147. language syntax

= formal rules governing valid structure in a programming/formal language
語言語法; 程式語言語法

EK. LANGUAGE SEMANTICS — COMPUTING/LINGUISTICS

148. language semantics

= study/specification of meaning
語義

Can refer to:

- natural language semantics
 - programming-language semantics
-

EL. NATURAL LANGUAGE PROCESSING

149. natural language processing / NLP

= computational methods for processing and working with human language
自然語言處理

Practice

1. The software uses **natural language processing**.
軟體使用自然語言處理技術。

Major modern technical compound.

EM. NATURAL LANGUAGE UNDERSTANDING

150. natural language understanding / NLU

= computational interpretation of meaning/intent in human language
自然語言理解

EN. NATURAL LANGUAGE GENERATION

151. natural language generation / NLG

= computational production of human-language text or speech
自然語言生成

EO. LANGUAGE MODEL

152. language model

Computing/AI:

= computational model that represents or predicts patterns in language
語言模型

Practice

1. The application uses a **language model**.
應用程式使用語言模型。

EP. LARGE LANGUAGE MODEL

153. large language model / LLM

= large-scale language model trained on extensive data to model and generate language
大型語言模型

Major modern AI term.

EQ. LANGUAGE GENERATION

154. language generation

= production of linguistic output by humans or computational systems; exact meaning depends on field
語言生成

ER. LANGUAGE DATA

155. language data

= textual, spoken, signed, or annotated linguistic data used for study/training
語言資料

ES. LANGUAGE CORPUS

156. language corpus / corpus

= structured collection of authentic language data used for linguistic analysis
語料庫

Important lexical neighbor.

ET. LANGUAGE DETECTION

157. language detection

= automatic identification of the language used in text/speech
語言偵測／語言識別

EU. LANGUAGE IDENTIFICATION

158. language identification

= determination of which language is being used
語言識別

EV. LANGUAGE SETTING

159. language setting

= software/device option controlling interface or content language
語言設定

EW. LANGUAGE PACK

160. language pack

= downloadable/additional software resources enabling another interface/spelling/translation
language
語言套件

EX. LANGUAGE SUPPORT

161. language support

Can mean:

A. technical support for displaying/inputting a language

語言支援

B. educational assistance for language learners

語言學習支援

Context decides.

EY. LANGUAGE VERSION

162. language version

= version of software/content in a particular language
語言版本

EZ. INTERFACE LANGUAGE

163. interface language

= language displayed by a software/device interface
介面語言

FA. METALANGUAGE

164. metalanguage

= language used to describe or discuss language itself
元語言；描述語言的語言

Examples:

- noun
- adjective
- subject
- tense

are part of grammatical metalanguage.

Practice

1. Teachers should introduce grammatical **metalanguage** carefully.
老師應小心教授文法元語言／術語。

FB. PARALANGUAGE

165. paralanguage

= non-lexical vocal features accompanying speech, such as pitch, volume, tempo, hesitation, laughter, etc.

副語言；伴隨語言的聲音特徵

Highly relevant to the passage's focus on tone and hesitation.

It differs from **body language**, which is visual/bodily.

FC. NONVERBAL LANGUAGE

166. nonverbal language / nonverbal communication

= communication without ordinary spoken/written words

非語言溝通

In strict academic writing, **nonverbal communication** is often more precise than treating all such behavior as literal "language."

FD. VERBAL LANGUAGE

167. verbal language

= communication using words

言語語言；文字／口頭語言

Depending on field, **verbal** may include both spoken and written words.

FE. RECEPTIVE LANGUAGE

168. receptive language

Education/speech-language field:

= ability to understand language one hears/sees/reads

語言理解能力; 接受性語言能力

FF. EXPRESSIVE LANGUAGE

169. expressive language

= ability to produce language to communicate thoughts/needs

語言表達能力

Practice

1. The assessment examines receptive and **expressive language**.
評估會檢視語言理解與語言表達能力。
-

FG. LANGUAGE DELAY

170. language delay

= language development occurring later than expected according to a developmental framework

語言發展遲緩

Technical developmental/clinical term.

FH. LANGUAGE DISORDER

171. language disorder

= clinical/developmental difficulty understanding and/or using language beyond expected variation

語言障礙

Technical clinical term; not synonymous with speech disorder.

FI. SPEECH vs LANGUAGE

172. speech

= production of spoken sounds/words

言語; 說話

173. language

= broader symbolic system involving vocabulary, grammar, meaning, comprehension, etc.

語言

A person can have a speech difficulty without having a language difficulty, and vice versa.

FJ. LANGUAGE vs DIALECT

174. language

= linguistic system conventionally recognized as a language

語言

175. dialect

= regional/social variety associated with a broader language or linguistic continuum

方言; 語言變體

The boundary between “language” and “dialect” can involve linguistic, historical, social, and political conventions; it is not determined by one simple structural test.

FK. LANGUAGE vs ACCENT

176. language

= complete linguistic system

語言

177. accent

= characteristic pronunciation associated with region, community, first language, etc.

口音

Compare:

Cantonese language

粵語這種語言

Cantonese accent in English

說英語時帶有粵語口音

FL. LANGUAGE vs REGISTER

178. register

= variety/style selected according to social situation or purpose

語域; 語體

language is broader.

Compare:

formal register

正式語體

FM. LANGUAGE vs STYLE

179. style

= characteristic manner of expression
風格

language

may mean the actual words and structures through which the style is realized.

FN. LANGUAGE vs TONE

180. language

= words/expressions being used
用語／措辭

181. tone

= attitude/emotional quality communicated through them
語氣／口吻

Compare:

polite language
有禮用語

friendly tone
友善口吻

FO. LANGUAGE vs VOCABULARY

182. vocabulary

= words known or used

詞彙

language

includes much more:

- vocabulary
 - grammar
 - meaning
 - sound/sign systems
 - discourse conventions
-

FP. LANGUAGE vs GRAMMAR

183. grammar

= structural rules/patterns for combining linguistic elements

文法; 語法

Grammar is one component of language.

FQ. LANGUAGE vs TERMINOLOGY

184. terminology

= specialized terms of a field

術語

language

can include terminology plus syntax, style, ordinary words, conventions, etc.

FR. LANGUAGE vs JARGON

185. jargon

= specialist insider language

行話／專門術語

Often carries a suggestion that outsiders may find it difficult.

FS. LANGUAGE vs WORDING

186. wording

= precise selection/arrangement of words in a particular statement

措辭

language

is broader.

FT. LANGUAGE vs COMMUNICATION

187. language

= one system/means used to communicate

語言

188. communication

= broader process of transmitting information/meaning

溝通

Communication can happen through:

- language
- gesture
- images
- facial expressions
- signals

Therefore:

all language use is communicative, but not all communication is language.

FU. LANGUAGE vs BODY LANGUAGE

189. ordinary language

= structured verbal/signed linguistic system
語言

190. body language

= bodily cues interpreted communicatively
肢體語言

The latter uses **language** metaphorically in ordinary usage.

FV. BODY LANGUAGE vs GESTURE

191. gesture

= individual movement that communicates
手勢; 動作

192. body language

= broader pattern of posture, expression, gaze, gestures, movement, etc.
肢體語言

A gesture is one component of body language.

FW. BODY LANGUAGE vs FACIAL EXPRESSION

193. facial expression

= configuration/movement of the face showing emotion or attitude
面部表情

It contributes to body language but is not identical to all body language.

FX. BODY LANGUAGE vs PARALANGUAGE

194. body language

= visual bodily cues
肢體語言

195. paralanguage

= vocal but non-word features, such as tone, volume, rhythm and hesitation
副語言

This distinction directly connects three passage words:

- **tone**
- **gesture/body language**
- **hesitation**

FY. FORMAL LANGUAGE — IMPORTANT DOUBLE MEANING

196. formal language — ordinary style

= polite/official/academic wording
正式用語

formal language in a business letter

197. formal language — mathematics/computing

= mathematically specified set of valid symbol strings
形式語言

Same phrase, completely different field.

FZ. NATURAL LANGUAGE — IMPORTANT CONTRAST

198. natural language

= naturally developed human language
自然語言

199. formal/programming language

= deliberately defined symbolic system
形式／程式語言

GA. PLAIN LANGUAGE vs SIMPLE LANGUAGE

200. plain language

= intentionally clear communication designed around audience understanding
簡明／淺白用語

201. simple language

= language that is not complex
簡單用語

Plain language is a more established professional communication concept.

GB. OFFENSIVE LANGUAGE vs ABUSIVE LANGUAGE

202. offensive language

= language likely to cause offense
冒犯性用語

203. abusive language

= language directly attacking, insulting, degrading, or threatening someone
辱罵性語言

Abusive language is generally more specifically directed at a target.

GC. BAD LANGUAGE vs STRONG LANGUAGE

204. bad language

= profanity/swearing
粗口；髒話

205. strong language

= strong, forceful, and often profane/offensive wording
強烈／粗俗用語

In media warnings, **strong language** commonly means profanity.

GD. LOADED LANGUAGE vs EMOTIVE LANGUAGE

206. loaded language

= wording carrying strong associations or bias
帶傾向的措辭

207. emotive language

= wording designed to arouse emotion
情緒性／煽情措辭

They often overlap but are not identical.

GE. LANGUAGE BARRIER vs COMMUNICATION BARRIER

208. language barrier

= inability/difficulty caused specifically by insufficient shared language
語言障礙

209. communication barrier

= any obstacle to successful communication
溝通障礙

The second is broader.

GF. LANGUAGE COMPETENCE vs LANGUAGE PERFORMANCE

210. language competence

Linguistics:

= underlying linguistic knowledge/ability
語言能力

211. language performance

= actual language use in real situations
語言表現; 實際語言使用

A classic theoretical distinction, though terminology varies by framework.

GG. LANGUAGE INPUT

212. language input

Language learning:

= language learners hear, see, or read and can learn from
語言輸入

GH. LANGUAGE OUTPUT

213. language output

= language produced by learners/speakers
語言輸出

GI. LANGUAGE EXPOSURE

214. language exposure

= amount/type of contact someone has with a language
語言接觸; 接觸某語言的機會

GJ. LANGUAGE PRACTICE

215. language practice

= activity intended to develop language skills
語言練習

GK. LANGUAGE ENVIRONMENT

216. language environment

= linguistic surroundings in which a person learns/uses language

語言環境

GL. LANGUAGE COMMUNITY / SPEECH COMMUNITY

217. language community

= community associated with use of a language

語言社群

Related sociolinguistic term:

speech community

→ 言語社群

GM. LANGUAGE RIGHTS

218. language rights

= rights relating to use, education, public services, recognition, etc. in particular languages

語言權利

GN. LANGUAGE ACCESS

219. language access

= provision enabling people with different language needs to understand/use services and information

語言無障礙; 語言服務可及性

May involve:

- interpretation
 - translation
 - multilingual materials
-

GO. LANGUAGE SERVICE

220. language services

= professional translation, interpreting, localization, language access, etc.

語言服務

GP. LANGUAGE INTERPRETER vs TRANSLATOR

221. interpreter

= person who renders spoken/signed communication between languages

傳譯員; 口譯員

222. translator

= person who normally renders written material between languages

翻譯員; 筆譯員

Useful language-field distinction.

GQ. LANGUAGE PAIR

223. language pair

Translation:

= two languages involved in translation/interpreting
語言對

Example:

English–Chinese language pair
英中語言對

GR. SOURCE / TARGET LANGUAGE — TRANSLATION MAP

224. source language

= original language
源語

225. target language

= language into which content is rendered
目標語／譯入語

GS. LANGUAGE LOCALIZATION

226. localization

= adapting content/software to a particular linguistic and cultural market
本地化

Broader than simple translation.

GT. CONTROLLED LANGUAGE

227. controlled language

= restricted form of a natural language with deliberately limited vocabulary/grammar for consistency or clarity
受控語言

Used in technical writing and some computational contexts.

GU. PLAIN-LANGUAGE MOVEMENT / PLAIN-LANGUAGE WRITING

228. plain-language writing

= writing designed for readers to find, understand, and use information easily
簡明寫作 ; 淺白文字

GV. LANGUAGE MODEL vs TRANSLATION MODEL

229. language model

= model of linguistic patterns/probabilities
語言模型

230. translation model

= model specifically designed/trained for translation tasks
翻譯模型

Not every language model is only a translation system.

GW. LANGUAGE GENERATION vs LANGUAGE UNDERSTANDING

231. language generation

= producing linguistic output
語言生成

232. language understanding

= interpreting linguistic meaning/intent
語言理解

GX. LANGUAGE TECHNOLOGY

233. language technology

= technologies involving human language, such as speech recognition, translation, NLP, etc.
語言科技

GY. SPEECH-LANGUAGE — COMPOUND

234. speech-language

Used in compounds such as:

speech-language pathologist
言語及語言治療專業人員

The exact professional title varies regionally.

GZ. LANGUAGE ARTS

235. language arts

Especially North American education:

= school subject area involving reading, writing, speaking, listening, literature, etc.
語文; 語言藝術科

HA. ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS / ELA

236. English Language Arts

= school subject combining English reading, writing, literature, speaking, etc.
英語語文科

HB. LANGUAGE LITERACY

237. literacy

= ability/practices involving reading and writing; broader modern uses exist
讀寫能力

language and **literacy** overlap educationally but are not synonyms.

HC. LANGUAGE AWARENESS

238. language awareness

= conscious understanding of how language works and how it is used
語言意識

HD. LANGUAGE APTITUDE

239. language aptitude

= capacity associated with ease/speed of language learning
語言學習能力／語言天賦

HE. LANGUAGE ANXIETY

240. language anxiety

= anxiety associated with learning/using another language
語言焦慮

Established language-learning research term.

HF. LANGUAGE TRANSFER

241. language transfer

= influence of one known language on another being learned/used

語言遷移

May be:

- facilitating
 - interfering
-

HG. CROSS-LANGUAGE

242. cross-language

= involving more than one language or relationships between languages

跨語言的

Example:

cross-language influence

跨語言影響

HH. MULTILINGUAL

243. multilingual

= using/known/involving multiple languages

多語的; 多語言的

Practice

1. She grew up in a **multilingual** household.
她在一個多語家庭長大。
-

HI. BILINGUAL

244. bilingual

= using/knowing two languages
雙語的; 能使用兩種語言的

HJ. MONOLINGUAL

245. monolingual

= using/knowing one language
單語的

HK. LINGUISTIC

246. linguistic

= relating to language or linguistics
語言的; 語言學的

Practice

1. The two varieties have important **linguistic differences**.
兩種變體有重要的語言差異。
-

HL. LINGUISTICALLY

247. linguistically

= from the perspective of language/linguistics
在語言上；從語言學角度

HM. LINGUIST

248. linguist

A. specialist who studies language scientifically

語言學家

B. sometimes, person skilled in languages

精通多種語言的人

The academic sense is especially important.

HN. LINGUISTICS

249. linguistics

= scientific study of language
語言學

Major related field word.

HO. LANGUAGING

250. languaging

Specialist education/applied-linguistics/social-theory term:

= using language as an active process of constructing, expressing, or developing meaning
以語言建構／發展意義的過程

This is specialist and much less common than **language**.

Do not treat it as a normal everyday -ing form.

HP. LANGUAGE AS A VERB — RARE/SPECIALIST

251. language something

Rare/specialist:

= express, formulate, or frame something in language
用語言表述；措辭表達

Example:

How we **language** an experience can affect how we understand it.

我們如何用語言表述一段經歷，可能影響我們如何理解它。

This use exists in some academic/therapeutic discourse but is **not a core everyday verb**.

For ordinary learner English, prefer:

- express
 - phrase
 - word
 - describe
-

HQ. KEY GRAMMAR: LANGUAGE — COUNTABLE

252. a language / languages

Used when referring to distinct linguistic systems:

learn a language

學一種語言

speak three languages

會說三種語言

HR. KEY GRAMMAR: LANGUAGE — UNCOUNTABLE

253. language

Used broadly for the human capacity/system or wording:

the development of language

語言的發展

offensive language

冒犯性用語

Not:

 an offensive language

if you mean “offensive wording.”

But:

an endangered language

is countable because it means a particular linguistic system.

HS. LEARN A LANGUAGE

254. learn a language

= acquire knowledge/ability in a particular language

學習一種語言

HT. SPEAK A LANGUAGE

255. speak a language

= be able to communicate orally in a language

會說某種語言

Important

 speak English

is normally more natural than:

 speak the English language

in ordinary conversation.

HU. USE A LANGUAGE

256. use a language

= communicate through a language

使用某種語言

HV. LANGUAGE USED IN SOMETHING

257. the language used in a document

= wording/style used
文件所採用的措辭／語言

Context decides whether this means:

- which linguistic system (English, Chinese), or
 - what wording/style.
-

HW. CHANGE THE LANGUAGE

258. change the language

Can mean:

A. switch interface/text to another language

更改語言

B. rewrite the wording

修改措辭

Context is essential.

HX. CHOOSE YOUR LANGUAGE CAREFULLY

259. choose one's language carefully

= choose words carefully
謹慎選擇措辭

Practice

1. When giving feedback, **choose your language carefully**.
提供意見時要慎選措辭。
-

HY. USE LANGUAGE TO...

260. use language to persuade / describe / criticize

= use words and linguistic choices for a communicative purpose
運用語言來.....

Common analysis construction.

HZ. LANGUAGE CAN SHAPE...

261. language shapes perception / relationships / discussion

= linguistic choices can influence how people frame and understand experiences
語言影響理解／關係／討論方式

This remains the broad communication-system sense rather than a separate lexical meaning.

IA. PASSAGE CONNECTION — BODY LANGUAGE vs WORDS

262. spoken language vs body language

In the passage:

spoken language

→ what characters say

body language

→ how posture, movement, gaze, etc. communicate additional meaning

Drama makes learners attend to both.

IB. PASSAGE CONNECTION — BODY LANGUAGE vs TONE

263. tone

= vocal manner

語氣

264. body language

= bodily/nonverbal cues

肢體語言

Compare:

“I’m fine.”

The words may be identical, but:

- a cold **tone**
- crossed arms
- looking away

can communicate a very different message.

IC. PASSAGE CONNECTION — BODY LANGUAGE vs GESTURE

265. gesture

= one particular expressive movement
手勢／動作

266. body language

= broader system/pattern of bodily cues
肢體語言

So:

gesture $\subset$ body language

in many contexts.

ID. PASSAGE CONNECTION — BODY LANGUAGE vs HESITATION

267. hesitation

= delay/pause indicating uncertainty, reluctance, difficulty, etc.
猶豫；遲疑

It can contribute to the interpretation of:

- spoken language
 - tone
 - body language
 - intention
-

IE. SEMANTIC MAP

The central concept of **LANGUAGE** is:

a structured or interpretable system used to communicate meaning

From this core, modern English develops several large branches.

A. Human linguistic systems

English language

→ 英語

first language

→ 第一語言

sign language

→ 手語

B. Words and wording

simple language

→ 簡單用語

legal language

→ 法律措辭

offensive language

→ 冒犯性用語

C. Characteristic expression

poetic language

→ 詩性語言

writer's language

→ 作者的表達方式

D. Figurative systems of communication

Passage

body language

→ 肢體語言

Also:

visual language

→ 視覺語言

musical language

→ 音樂語言

language of mathematics

→ 數學語言

Here **language** means a recognizable system of meaningful signs/forms rather than necessarily words.

E. Computing

programming language

→ 程式語言

machine language

→ 機器語言

formal language

→ 形式語言

F. AI / language technology

natural language processing

→ 自然語言處理

language model

→ 語言模型

large language model

→ 大型語言模型

The broad semantic progression is:

human communication system → particular language → chosen wording/style → specialized system of expression → formal/computational system.

IF. MASTER COMPARISON — MCQ-READY

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
body language — passage	透過姿勢、表情、眼神、手勢、動作等傳達意思的肢體語言
language — general human system	人類用聲音、符號、詞彙、語法等傳遞意義的語言系統
a language	英語、中文等一套特定的語言系統
spoken language	以口頭聲音表達的語言；口語
written language	以文字表達的語言；書面語
sign language	主要透過手形、動作、位置等構成的完整自然手語
natural language	自然在人類社群中發展的語言
human language	人類所具有／使用的語言系統
first language / L1	一個人最早習得的第一語言
native language	自幼自然習得的母語
mother tongue	母語
second language / L2	在第一語言以外學習／使用的第二語言
foreign language	本地環境中非主要使用的外國語言
additional language	在已有語言之外再學習的語言
target language — learning	學習者正在學習的目標語

target language — translation	翻譯所譯入的語言
source language	翻譯原文所使用的源語
heritage language	與家庭／族群傳承相關的傳承語
community language	某社群內使用的語言
minority language	少數群體所使用的語言
dominant language	在社會／制度上較具主導地位的語言
official language	獲政府／制度正式指定使用的官方語言
national language	與國家身分具有正式／象徵關係的國家語言
common/shared language	各方共同能使用的語言；亦可比喻共同語彙／框架
lingua franca	母語不同人士之間使用的共同通用語
living language	仍被社群日常自然使用的活語言
dead language	已不再作為社群日常母語傳承的語言
extinct language	已沒有使用者的滅絕語言
endangered language	使用者逐漸減少、有消亡風險的瀕危語言
language revitalization	恢復／加強瀕危語言使用及傳承的語言復振
classical language	具有重要歷史／文學傳統的古典語言
constructed language	人為有意設計的人工構造語
artificial language	人工設計而非自然演變的語言／形式系統
language family	由共同祖語發展出的語言群；語系
language variety	因地區、社群、情境等形成的語言變體
standard language	經制度／教育標準化的標準語
language acquisition	語言能力逐步形成的語言習得過程

second-language acquisition	第二／額外語言習得
language learning	學習一種語言的過程
language development	語言理解與表達能力隨時間發展的過程
language skills	聽、說、讀、寫等語言技能
language proficiency	使用某語言的熟練程度
language barrier	因沒有足夠共同語言而產生的溝通障礙
language exchange	兩人／多人互助練習彼此語言的語言交換
language immersion	大量使用／接觸目標語的沉浸式學習
language of instruction	學校／課程用來教授內容的授課語言
language policy	規管／引導機構或社會語言使用的語言政策
language planning	有組織地影響語言地位、形式或使用的語言規劃
language contact	不同語言／說話者長期互動形成的語言接觸
language change	語音、文法、詞彙等隨時間發生的語言演變
language shift	社群逐步改用另一語言的語言轉移
language maintenance	社群持續維持並傳承某語言
language — wording	某文件／說話中使用的詞語與措辭
plain language	為方便讀者理解而使用的直接、淺白用語
formal language — style	適合正式情境的正式用語／語體
informal language	較輕鬆、口語化的非正式用語
colloquial language	日常口語式表達
academic language	學術學習與寫作常用的語言形式
technical language	某技術領域的專門用語

legal language	法律文件／法律領域使用的專業措辭
medical language	醫學專業用語
jargon	某行業／群體使用、外人可能難懂的行話
terminology	某專業領域的一整套術語
wording	某句／文件精確選用和排列的措辭
figurative language	使用比喻、擬人等非純字面意義的修辭語言
literal language	按直接字面意思表達的語言
descriptive language	用於生動描寫事物的語言
persuasive language	旨在影響他人觀點／行為的說服性語言
emotive language	用來引起強烈情緒反應的情感性措辭
loaded language	帶有強烈聯想、評價或傾向的措辭
neutral language	盡量避免強烈價值判斷的中性用語
inclusive language	盡量避免排斥／污名化群體的共融用語
discriminatory language	帶有歧視意味的語言
offensive language	可能冒犯、侮辱他人的用語
strong language	尤其媒體警示：強烈、粗俗或帶髒話的用語
bad language	粗言穢語；髒話
foul language	粗俗、猥褻或嚴重冒犯性的粗言
abusive language	對他人作辱罵、羞辱等的言語
threatening language	傳達威脅的言語
obscene language	猥褻／極粗俗用語
colourful language	可指生動措辭；亦可委婉指粗俗／強烈用語

watch/mind your language	注意用詞；不要說髒話／無禮說話
excuse my language	為剛才／即將使用的粗俗、強烈措辭致歉
language — manner of expression	某作者／人物所採用的表達方式與語言風格
poetic language	富有詩意／詩歌特徵的語言
literary language	文學作品特有的表達方式
diplomatic language	為避免衝突而使用的委婉、謹慎措辭
precise language	意義準確、界線清楚的用語
vague language	缺乏精確意思的模糊用語
ambiguous language	可以有多於一種理解的歧義性用語
read body language	解讀某人的姿勢、表情、手勢等非語言訊息
the language of something	某領域用來表達意思的一整套符號／形式／慣例
visual language	透過色彩、形狀、構圖等傳達意思的視覺語言
cinematic language	電影利用鏡頭、剪接、聲音等建立的表達系統
musical language	音樂作品／作曲家特有的音樂表達方式
language of mathematics	數學符號、術語及表達規則構成的數學語言
love language	流行關係框架中一個人偏好的愛意表達／接收方式
speak the same language — literal	能使用同一種語言
speak the same language — figurative	有共同想法／共同語彙，容易互相理解
speak someone's language	用對方特別能理解／認同的方式表達；說到對方心坎
programming language	用來編寫電腦程式的形式語言

high-level language	與硬體細節較抽離的高階程式語言
low-level language	接近硬體／機器指令的低階程式語言
machine language	處理器可直接執行的機器語言
assembly language	以符號指令表示機器操作的組合語言
scripting language	常用於自動化／腳本工作的程式語言
query language	用來查詢／操作資料的查詢語言
markup language	用標記描述文件／資料結構的標記語言
domain-specific language	專為某特定領域設計的程式／形式語言
formal language — computing/math	由明確規則定義合法符號串的形式語言
natural language processing	電腦處理人類自然語言的自然語言處理
natural language understanding	電腦分析／理解自然語言意義的技術
natural language generation	電腦產生自然語言內容的技術
language model	建模語言模式／機率的計算模型
large language model	以大規模資料訓練的大型語言模型
language detection	自動判斷文字／語音屬於哪種語言
language setting	軟體／裝置的顯示語言設定
language pack	為軟體加入另一語言資源的語言套件
language support	技術上的語言支援, 或教育上的語言學習支援
metalanguage	用來描述／討論語言本身的元語言
paralanguage	說話時伴隨詞語的音高、音量、節奏、停頓等副語言特徵
receptive language	理解別人語言的接受性／語言理解能力

expressive language	用語言表達思想、需求等的語言表達能力
language disorder	理解／使用語言方面的臨床性困難
language arts	尤其北美學校的讀寫、文學、聽說等語文科
language awareness	對語言結構及使用方式的自覺認識
language aptitude	學習語言方面的潛在能力
language anxiety	學習／使用另一語言時產生的焦慮
language transfer	已知語言對另一語言學習／使用產生的遷移影響
multilingual	使用／涉及多種語言的
bilingual	能使用／涉及兩種語言的
monolingual	只使用／涉及一種語言的
linguistic	與語言／語言學有關的
linguist	語言學家；較廣義亦可指精通語言的人
linguistics	科學研究語言的語言學
linguaging	專門術語：透過實際使用語言來建構／發展意義
language — rare verb	專門／少見：把經驗或概念用語言表述出來

IG. PASSAGE RECAP

“At first glance, the task looked simple; on closer inspection, it forced us to consider tone, **body language** and responsibility.”

Here, the relevant lexical unit is:

body language

not simply:

language = English/Chinese

Passage meaning

body language

= the attitudes, emotions, and intentions communicated through posture, facial expression, eye movement, gestures, and other bodily behavior

Best Traditional Chinese:

- 肢體語言
- 身體語言

Natural contextual translation:

乍看之下，這項任務似乎很簡單；但仔細分析，就會發現它迫使我們考慮語氣、肢體語言和責任。

Passage MCQ-ready interpretation of LANGUAGE

Within **body language**:

language

= a system or means through which meaning is communicated

傳達意思的方式／表意系統

The biggest learner branches are:

English is a language.

→ 英語是一種語言

language development

→ 語言發展

legal language

→ 法律用語／法律措辭

strong language

→ 粗俗／強烈用語

watch your language

→ 注意你的用詞／別說髒話

body language

→ 肢體語言

visual language

→ 視覺語言

speak the same language

→ 字面：說同一種語言

→ 比喻：有共同語言／想法合拍

programming language

→ 程式語言

formal language

→ 日常語境：正式用語

→ 電腦／數學：形式語言

natural language processing

→ 自然語言處理

language model

→ 語言模型

large language model

→ 大型語言模型

metalanguage

→ 元語言

paralanguage

→ 副語言

The central semantic idea tying these together is:

LANGUAGE = an organized way of representing and communicating meaning.

That organization may consist of:

- words and grammar,
- manual signs,
- bodily cues,
- artistic conventions,
- mathematical symbols,
- computer instructions,
- or formal symbolic rules.

In the passage, **body language** matters because drama teaches students that people communicate much more than the literal words they say. A character's posture, gaze, movement, physical distance, facial expression, and gesture can change how the audience interprets the same sentence—just as **tone** and **hesitation** can.